

James Oehring

Data Driven Technology Executive | Enterprise AI Strategy and Governance

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Hiring Committee
AI Office Lead (Requisition #36517)
Dairy Farmers of America
Kansas City, Kansas

Dear Hiring Manager,

I'm applying for the AI Office Lead role. Standing up a net-new AI Office is what I do right now, and doing it for a farmer-owned cooperative, where AI has to earn its keep for 10,000 family farmers rather than chase novelty, is the kind of mandate I want. As Chief AI Officer I built one from the ground up, from the roadmap and operating model to the governance and the network that got people actually using it.

The job comes down to owning the AI lifecycle from intake to production and keeping every initiative tied to business value. I've put 15+ generative AI use cases into production, each scored on ROI, feasibility, and risk before it got funded. Governance is built in, not bolted on. I co-authored our Responsible AI Policy with legal and compliance, and I report portfolio progress, risk, and spend to an AI Steering Committee.

Adoption is where AI actually pays off. I built a network of AI Champions across non-technical business units, and upskilled 200+ people at 11 companies. That's the same IT-to-business bridge DFA needs across manufacturing, corporate, and milk marketing. Earlier I built an IT function and its governance from zero for a 600-person organization and cut vendor spend by \$245,000 a year. DFA's CoLAB work tells me this is a place that values innovation grounded in real operations.

I'd welcome the chance to talk about helping DFA stand up its AI Office. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

James Oehring